

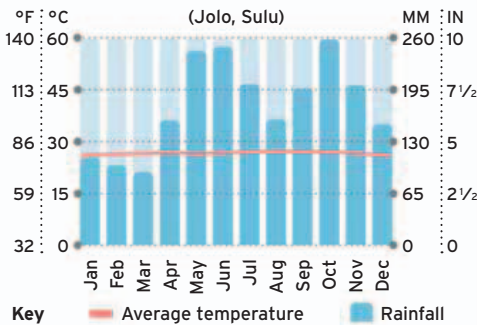
LOCATION



This marine ecoregion is in Southeast Asia, between the Philippines in the north and east Malaysia to the west and Indonesia to the south.

CLIMATE

This marine ecoregion has a tropical monsoon climate with plentiful rainfall and seasonal typhoons, particularly in the north and center.



Spinner dolphin

Stenella longirostris



Spinner dolphins get their name from their ability to twirl several times in midair as they leap clear of the sea. Like most dolphin species, spinners are highly social, grouping together in schools that may range from under 200 to 1,000 or more individuals. They often swim with other dolphins and whales as well as fish such as yellowfin and skipjack tuna—a habit that results in many of these mammals dying in commercial tuna nets as bycatch.

Shallow sleepers, deep feeders

Although they are deep-water feeders, spinner dolphins retreat to areas safe from predators to rest during the day, usually frequenting the same area such as an inlet, bay, or shallow water. Hunting and feeding occur mainly at night, which is also when they do most of their leaping. Spinner dolphins use touch, such as nudges or flipper rubbing, whistles, and also echolocation to keep in contact with members of their group. They mate year round, and females give birth to a single calf, which stays with its mother for around seven years.

- 4–9 ft (1.2–2.7 m)
- 99–175 lb (45–80 kg)
- Not known
- Fish, squid, shrimp



Tropical waters worldwide

Spinner dolphins make a **series of leaps**, often as many as **14 in a row**

▽ AQUATIC ACROBAT

Theories for the reason behind the spinner's trademark leaps include communication with other dolphins, parasite-removal, or sheer joy.



MULTIFACETED GRASS
Seagrass beds are vital to the marine ecosystem. They are a food source for dugongs and turtles and a nursery habitat for young fish. They also clean the water of chemicals, recycle nutrients, and help stabilize sandy sediments on the seafloor.

SEAGRASS

sea turtle live in these waters